

IBM Deskstar 120GXP hard disk

For all your data storage needs

IBM ruled the performance segment with its 75GXP series and now its 120GXP promises to take that legacy to new heights. This is a 120 GB drive (40 GB per platter) mainly targeted at high-end desktop systems and entry-level workstations. The drive was tested using HDtach 2.61 on a Pentium 4 2.4 GHz powered machine along with 256 MB RDRAM. Its scores were average, with a sequential read score of 38 Mbps and 24 Mbps for sequential write speed. The sequential write speed is fairly low and we were quite disappointed with the effort—an average 7,200-rpm drive scores over 35 Mbps for sequential read/write scores. The CPU utilisation for the drive when tested with the high-end disk Winmark 99 was 9.58 per cent,



which is again a little on the higher side for drives of this class. The average access time of the drive was also higher at 12.1 ms, which is 4 ms higher than the rated 8.5 ms. The drive gets very hot while in operation and it would be advised not to cram it in an overcrowded cabinet without adequate cooling as it could damage the drive due to excessive heat.

SPECIFICATIONS
120 GB, ATA/100 7,200-rpm drive, 2 MB buffer

Price: Rs 16,500
Contact: Wales Technology
Phone: 022-3828100
E-mail: sales@walestechnology.com
Web site: www.ibm.com

IBM Deskstar 120GXP B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

StepUp 1.6

Data migration

This software from Techno Pundits promises a fast and reliable way of migrating data, applications and settings between PCs.

This program is ideal for users who can't remember or redo all of those complicated settings or use floppies to move data. In order to transfer the data, you will require a parallel port with a parallel cable or an Ethernet card with a direct crossover cable. Unfortunately, this version cannot transfer data with a USB crossover



cable. The migration process is Wizard-driven where you will have to select the type of connection you are using and the components you want to migrate. This software gives you two migration options: Mass Migration and Selective Migration. The Mass Migration option allows you to migrate all the components, i.e. supported and unsupported applications, from the source PC to the destination PC. Hence, it is very likely that some of the migrated applications not supported by this version may not function

as desired. On the other hand, Selective Migration gives the user the flexibility of selecting the components to be migrated. For ease of use, the settings are organised into four groups: desktop, network settings, applications and data explorer.

Overall, the software is easy to use and is invaluable to those who frequently change setups or to system

Price: Rs 1,223
Contact: Techno Pundits Systems Private Ltd
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administrators who want to replicate system settings across a network. However, this program has certain limitations such as the absence of support for Mac machines or DOS-based applications.

SPECIFICATIONS
System Requirements: A P-II processor or above, 64 MB RAM or more, 45 MB of hard disk space, parallel port or network card with UTP interface

StepUp 1.6 A-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

ADCOM DG-300 TOY-CAM

Just point and click

The DG-300 TOY-CAM has a radical shape and supports a maximum resolution of 640x480. It sports 8 MB of memory with a USB 1.1 interface, which makes connecting it to the PC easy and fast. The captured image is around 225 KB in size, and 36 images can be stored on average. Strangely, the camera allowed only 26 images to be clicked in one go when we tested it! We could not get past this limitation despite trying to use a lower resolution of 320x240. The image appeared grainy when uploaded on the PC using the bundled software. ZLink Photo123 allows the user to add effects to the image such as distort image, pentagon filter and cubic photo. The shape, however, is very awkward, which makes taking pictures a



tad difficult for users with big hands and the button placement makes it difficult to keep your hands stable while clicking. The camera runs on two AAA batteries when detached, and when connected to the PC, it draws the power directly from the USB interface. It's capable of capturing video at five different settings (640x480, 352x288, 320x240, 176x144 and 160x120 pixels). The rubber stand provided with the camera doesn't provide enough grip and causes the camera to drift when the cable is stretched. The camera is good for younger users and makes for a fun birthday gift.

SPECIFICATIONS
300 K pixel CMOS sensor, 8 MB built-in memory, USB 1.1 compliant, maximum resolution of 640x480

Price: Rs 4,600
Contact: Advantage Computers India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-8260215
Fax: 022-8258335
E-mail: advantagetime@vsnl.net
Web site: www.advantagetime.com

ADCOM DG-300 B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶